

**Board 1**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3  
♥ J 10 8 5  
♦ J 6  
♣ Q 10 8 7 3

♠ A 10 9  
♥ K Q 6 4  
♦ A 9 5 2  
♣ A 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K Q J 8 6 4  
♥ 9 2  
♦ Q 8 7  
♣ 9 4

♠ 5 2  
♥ A 7 3  
♦ K 10 4 3  
♣ K J 6 2

|              |              |             |              |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|              |              | 2 ♠         | Pass         |
| Pass         | 2NT          | Pass        | 3NT          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by North |              |             |              |

Partner's 1NT overcall shows 15-18 points and guarantees a ♠ stop. With 11 points and no 4-card ♥ suit you say 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by South.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠K. Do you hold up or not?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 8

You need just one more winner. It could come from a finesse of the ♣J. It could come from a 3-3 ♥ split. It could come by establishing a fourth card in ♦s.

Most important for now is the ♠ lead? Do you hold up?

Yes you should hold up. In fact you might as well hold up twice since you aren't contemplating a throw-in of East. Holding up twice will protect you in the unlikely event that East made his 2 ♠ bid with a 5-card suit.

Both the ♥ possibility and the ♣ possibility will either work or not, so you can save them for later. Your highest percentage chance is the fourth ♦, but here you must be careful. You must try to establish the ♦s without allowing East to get the lead. It is actually pretty easy. Just play a small ♦ from your hand and when East plays low insert the ♦10. West wins the ♦J but cannot harm you with his return.

When the remaining ♦s fall you have established your ninth trick.

Suppose East inkles out what you are trying to do and inserts his ♦Q when you play the low ♦ toward dummy?

If he does that he hands you all four ♦ tricks!

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 5  
 ♥ K 10 4  
 ♦ J 10 9 5  
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ J 9 8 6 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 6 2

♣ A Q

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 7

♥ Q J 9 6 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ K 10 5 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8

♦ A K 7 3

♣ 9 8 6 2

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♥    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass     | 3♠    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3♠ by South and another ♠ you could go down. Remember that you only counted one ♥ loser - that means you MUST ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Win the ♦ lead and play ♥ A and another ♥ before you touch trumps.

After this there is nothing the defense can do to stop you ruffing one ♥ in your hand.

Just suppose for an instant that you had played ♠ A and another.

West would have taken the second ♠, then pulled your last ♠. When the ♣ finesse failed you would make only 8 tricks.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♠.

Partner now bids 3♠.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♠.

Partner now bids 3♠.

Partner tells you that he has only invitational strength, but has at least 6 ♠s. The ♠s are fine by you, but with only 15 HCP you decide to pass.

South plays 3♠. West leads the ♦ J. UhOh. Maybe you should have bid game.

Loser List: ♠ = ? : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = ?

If the ♠s are 2-2 there will be only one loser in that suit. And maybe the ♣ finesse will work.

Don't get too optimistic too early. If you play ♠ A

**Board 5**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 5 2

♥ Q J 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A 10

♥ K 7 4 3

♦ A 6 5 4

♣ A Q 5



♠ 7 4

♥ A 10 9 8

♦ Q J 10 8

♣ J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 6 3

♥ 6 2

♦ K 7 3

♣ K 6 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

With 12 points and a 5-card Major you transfer partner to that Major. You bid 2♥. Partner bids 2♠. Now what do say next?

With 12 points and a 5-card Major you transfer partner to that Major. You bid 2♥. Partner bids 2♠. Now what do say next?

You must insist on game, but since partner could have a doubleton ♠ you do so by bidding 3NT to give him the choice.

He chooses 3NT by passing.

The contract would be 3NT played by South.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♦Q. Do you win the first trick or holdup?

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

A holdup wouldn't hurt you since East would retain the lead. But it probably wouldn't help you much either since you do have 2 stoppers in the suit. You obviously need to establish at least one more winner in ♠s so you won't have to depend on the ♥A being with West. Need it be said that ♥s is the suit you are worried about and West is the Danger hand? Let's say you win the first trick with dummy's ♦K.

Suppose you play ♠A, then ♠K Q. If they split 3-3 you will be soooo happy because you will make at least 10 tricks. But if West shows out on the third ♠ you will be pretty happy because you can give up a ♠ to East and still make at least 9 tricks. But if East shows out on the third ♠ you could be in deep trouble. You would have to give West the lead to establish an extra ♠ winner, and he might very well lead through your ♥K.

There is a great safety play to protect against a 4-2 ♠ split. Play a low ♠ from dummy and finesse the ♠10. East may win with a doubleton ♠J but you will still make the contract.

With this layout the safety play finesse actually works and you make an overtrick.

But visualize the ♠J and ♠7 transposed. If you don't make the safety play it is true that the ♠J will fall. BUT, West will still take the fourth ♠ and when he gets in he will return the ♥Q.